Diploma in Lightroom

Getting organised

Importing photos to Lightroom

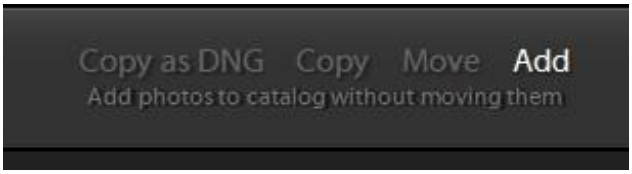
What can I import?

You can import any photo or video files into Lightroom. These can be located on the computer's drive, from an external hard drive or any media device such as a memory card or USB key, or even directly from your camera.

How to import:

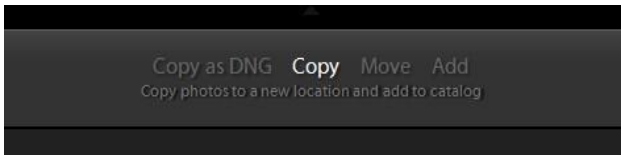
You can import from the file menu and select Import. You can also simply select the import option located in the bottom left corner of the interface when the Library Module is selected. Lightroom has multiple import options – **ADD, COPY, COPY AS DNG and MOVE.** Let's explore these options.

ADD



This option is used when we have files that are already located on the computer. Click Import and your importing interface will appear. Here on the left hand side you can select your photos. Click include subfolders to ensure that all your folders appear. The ADD option should be selected by default but you can select it at the top of the screen (refer to the lesson if you are unsure where this is located). This option will import photos into the Lightroom catalogue and leave them where they are located on your hard drive. You are simply adding the photos to the catalogue and can now start working on them in Lightroom.

COPY



If importing from an external device such as a camera or card reader we will need to copy the photos to the computer as well as adding them to Lightroom. At the top, click **Copy**. The Add and Move options are not available when importing from a camera. You can uncheck photos you don't want to import. On the right, in the **Destination** panel, choose how to organize imported photos (by date, into one selected folder, or by subfolders), and preview the import destination in your file structure. You also can choose additional import options on the right. Your photos will now be copied onto the computer in the location you have chosen and will be ready to work on in Lightroom.

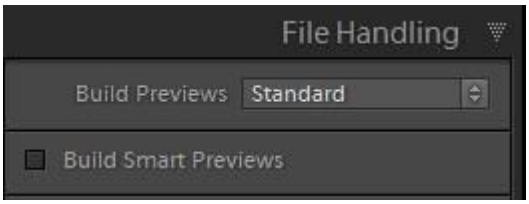
COPY AS DNG

This option Copies photos to the folder you choose and converts any camera raw files to the Digital Negative (DNG) format. A DNG is a file format created by Adobe to be read in most other editing programs and exists as a way to archive your photos. This is a good way to work in the long term but to begin I recommend you avoid this option. You can always convert files to DNG at a later stage.

MOVE

The Move option will allow you to import files that already are on the computer but unlike the ADD option you can chose a new location to store these files. If you are moving already existing files to an external hard drive this is a good option to select.
In general the COPY and the ADD options are the two that you are most likely going to be using when importing into Lightroom.

Previews – what one should I select?



When Importing Photos to Lightroom you will see an option to create Previews and Multiple sizes to select. Previews are the size of the photo you are viewing in Lightroom. The smaller the size the quicker the import but the more rendering Lightroom will need to do in the program. Previews can be changed after import if necessary. There are 4 options. These are:

Minimal

Minimal shows the thumbnail preview embedded in the file. It's the quickest option initially, but it's a very small low quality preview (i.e. usually with a black edging and about 160 px along the long edge) so you then have to wait to render previews as you browse.

Standard

Standard builds a standard-sized preview used for browsing through the photos. You set the size and quality of these previews in Catalog Settings. Standard-sized previews are highly recommended – it will greatly speed up browsing performance if Lightroom isn't having to render previews on the fly.

Embedded and Sidecar

Embedded & Sidecar checks the files and their sidecar files for larger previews, giving you the largest ready-built preview it can. It's still just a temporary option – Lightroom will build its own previews assoon as it can.

1:1

1:1 previews are full resolution so they take up more space, but if you wish to zoom in on your photos in Library

module, it will save Lightroom having to render 1:1 previews on the fly, which would slow your browsing experience. If you're concerned about the disc space that they take up, you can set them to delete after a fixed time (in Catalog Settings), or you can discard 1:1 previews on demand by selecting the photos and choosing Library menu > Previews > Discard 1:1 Previews.
Choose whichever suits your needs but 1:1 is most effective. There is one option here that is not mentioned however: **Smart previews.**

What are Smart Previews?

If you prefer to store your photos on an external drive it may not always be possible to have that drive available to work on your photos. So what can you do? This is where Smart previews come in. Smart Previews in Lightroom allow you to edit images that are not physically connected to your computer.
You can perform all edits that you would perform on the original file. Smart previews will automatically sync any edits made on Smart Preview files with your original files, as soon as the device is reconnected to your computer. Once created, your Smart Preview files are always up to date. When your storage device is connected, any edits you make to the original file are applied instantly to the Smart Previews as well.

What is the Library Module?

The Library module is where you view, sort, manage, organize, compare, and rate the photos in your catalog. It's your home for working with photos after importing them into Lightroom. The first thing toexplore are the view modes.

View Modes

The Library module offers several view modes that let you see your photos in different sizes and easily compare them. Switch between views using the keyboard shortcuts indicated.

Grid view (G)

Grid view displays photos as thumbnails in cells, which can be viewed in compact and expanded sizes. The Grid view gives you an overview of your entire catalog or specific groups of photos for rotating, sorting, organizing, and managing. You can use the + and – keys to increase and decrease the cell sizes or you can use the Thumbnail slider on the tool bar.

Loupe view (E)

Displays a single photo. Controls let you view the entire photo or zoom in to see part of it. Zoom levels up to 11:1 are available. When you're in the Grid or Survey view, double-clicking a photo displays the image in Loupe view. You can also zoom in to photos by clicking in the Navigator panel or by selecting a magnification level at the top of the Navigator panel.

Compare view

Displays photos side by side so that you can evaluate them. This is very useful for compare like for like photos. This can only be used with two photos at a time.

Survey view (N)

You can select multiple photos and view them. The active photo has the lightest coloured cell. Change the active photo by clicking a different thumbnail, and deselect a photo in Survey view by clicking the X in the lower-right corner of the thumbnail.

Lights Out (L)

You can dim the lights or turn them off altogether in Lightroom. Simply press L once to dim, then again to turn off the lights. Press it again to turn them back on. Very useful for removing all the clutter and assessing the photo clearly.

Remove Panels.

Shift + Tab removes all panels quickly. Very useful for enlarging your work space. Press again to bring everything back. You can also expand the cells with the letter J. This is useful to see the file name and any flags or ratings you have applied to the photos.

Find and filter photos.

When you have hundreds or thousands of photos, locating a specific image might not be as easy as simply selecting a folder or a collection. Luckily, the Library Filter bar at the top of the Grid view can help. The Library Filter bar lets you find photos by various types of metadata: keyword, rating, colourlabel, and more.

1. Select one or more folders or collections to search. Or, select All Photographs in the Catalog panel.
2. Press \ to display the Library Filter bar if it's not visible.
3. In the Library Filter bar, select a criteria by which to filter. If you want to find all photos with a certain keyword, for example, click Text. If you want to sort by rating, click attribute etc.
4. Specify filter criteria. For example, choose Text > Keywords > Contains All and type *portraits* in the search box. For a text filter, press Enter (Windows) or (Return).

The Library Filter bar

Photos that meet your criteria appear in the Grid view.

You can also filter photos by using the Filter menu in the upper-right corner of the Filmstrip.

Star Ratings

When assigning ratings to files, you can award from zero to five stars. Rating stars can be set or displayed in any view of the Library module. Once photos are rated, you can click a rating filter button in the Filmstrip or in the Library Filter bar to display and work on photos that you've rated with a specific number of stars. 0 -5 on the keyboard will quickly assign a star rating to the photo. Think of ratings like of you were reviewing a movie or hotel and rate your photos accordingly.

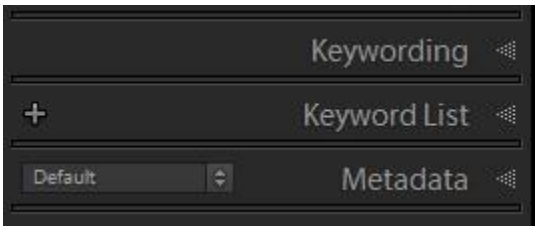
Flags

Flags are used to filter photos further. The white flag (P) is a pick. The black flag (X) is a rejected photo. You can remove a flag with U. Picked photos can be used for photos you want to keep. Rejected photos can be easily removed by rejecting them then using the filter to show the rejected photos. From here you can select the Photo option from the menu and delete or removed rejected photos.

Colours

Labelling photos with a certain colour is a flexible way to quickly mark a large number of photos. For example, suppose you've just imported a large number of photos and are viewing them in the Grid view. As you review each new photo, you can label the ones you want to keep. After this initial pass, you can click the colour label filter buttons in the Filmstrip to display and work on photos that you've labelled with a particular colour. Colours carry no meaning and you can assign them as you wish. For example RED maybe photos you want to print, YELLOW for photos to put on your website, GREEN for social media etc.

Metadata and Keywords.

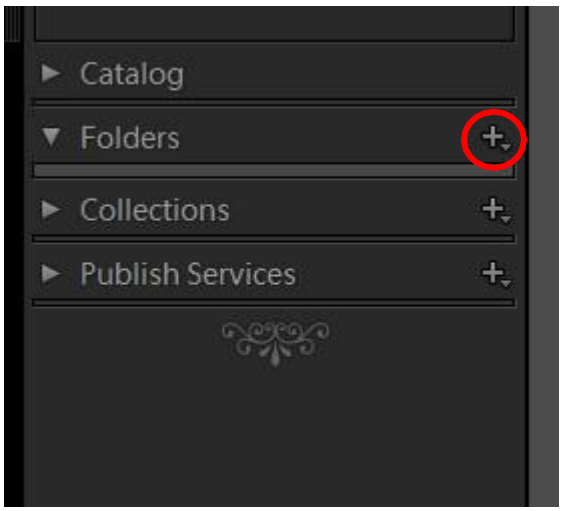


Applying keywords and metadata are additional tools for organizing and finding photos.

Keywords are text metadata that describe the important contents of a photo. You tag photos with keywords using the Keywording and Keyword Lists panels. For example, select a photo in the Grid view, and in the text entry box in the Keywording panel, enter words separated by commas.
Metadata is a set of standardized information about a photo, such as the photographer's name; the image resolution and colour space; and copyright information. Most digital cameras attach some basic metadata — such as height, width, file format, and the time the image was taken — to a photo (also known as the EXIF data) but you can edit that information and add more in the Library module.

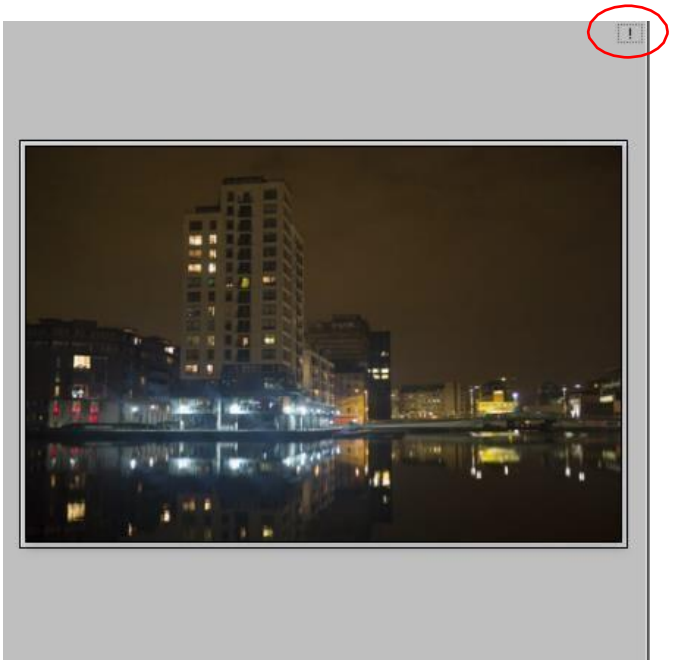
Creating new Folders

On the folder Tab you can create new folders. These will be created on the Hard drive as well.

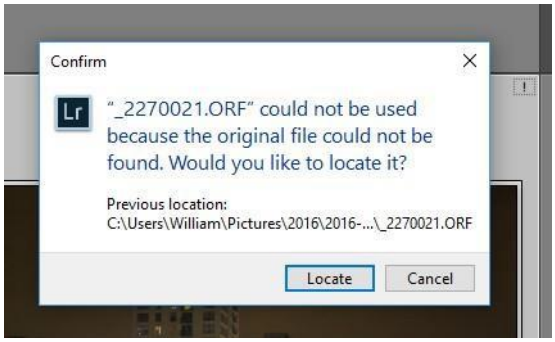


You can choose to create a new folder or you can create subfolders. You can you move photos to folders simply by clicking and dragging on them to the desired folder.

Relinking missing photos

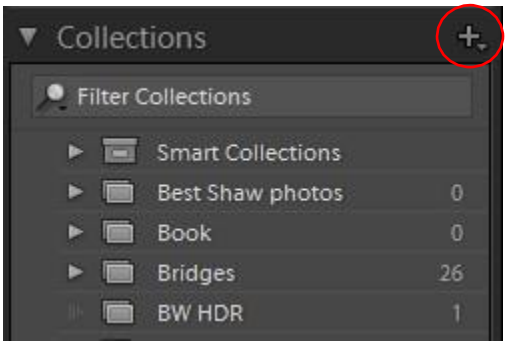


If you make a change to a photo in another program such as renaming a photo or move a file outside Lightroom you will see the ! appear. If it is a folder of photos you will see a ? appear. This does not necessarily mean that your photos have gone missing but the link to the catalog has been broken. No need to panic. To repair it is very straightforward. Click the ! and a new box will appear.



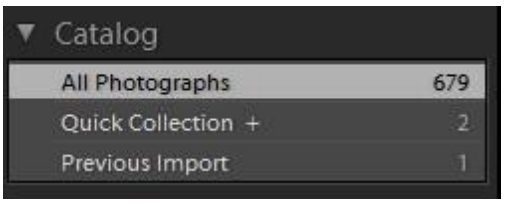
Here you can see it is telling you the file is missing and what its previous location was. Click Locate and finder/explorer will appear and you can locate the file. When you do Lightroom will ask you to confirm that this is the correct file and you simply click OK and the link is mended! The best way to avoid this is the rename, edit and move your files in Lightroom!

Collections



Collections are a way to group photos together in Lightroom without once created, collections are listed in the Collections panel of every module. They can be selected anytime you need them. You can create as many collections as you need moving them from their location. Think of collections like you would a playlist in a music player. You can have the same photo in as many collections as you like. There are many different types available. To create a collection, simply press the + button beside the collection tab.
Regular Collection – these are collections that you can simply drag and drop photos into. These can be changed into target collections. These are explained a little later.

Smart Collections – these are populated on rules that you define. For example, you can create a smart collection of all photos that have a five-star rating and a red colour label. Photos that meet the criteria are automatically added to the smart collection.
Quick/Target Collections



In the Catalog tab you will see the Quick collection. Note the + symbol beside it. This indicates that this is a target

collection. With a target collection you can quickly add photos to it by pressing the B on the keyboard. You can assign any collection as a target collection. Simply highlight the collection and Right click/Ctrl+Click to bring up your options. You will see the target collection option. You can only have one Target collection at a time. By default the quick collection is set as the target collection.

Collection Sets

These contain several collections of any type and are used to further organise yourself inLightroom.